



Moving On

It can be difficult to give up a venture you have nurtured from the start, but eventually someone else may need to take over. Start succession planning early so that you are well prepared when you step away.

Choosing a successor

Preparing to hand over control is a challenging task for any business—whether you plan to sell your business, retain ownership but hire someone else to run the operation, or bring in a family member. There could be a number of reasons to seek a successor. You may be ready to retire or want to spend more time on personal projects, or you may have achieved all of your goals and decides to focus your attention on exciting new ventures. If your business is stagnating, it could benefit from a transfer of power. Whether you have run out of steam or are busy with other new projects,

succession can provide a chance to find someone with different strengths ready to help expand the business and bring fresh energy and ideas.

Succession planning is not just a task for the end of your career. It should be considered well before retirement. An unexpected event could leave your business without clear leadership, so you need a backup plan to keep the operation running in your absence, for the benefit of both your employees and family. Consider the shape you would like your business to take when you have moved on. To preserve the value of your business, it is vital that whoever

Handing over

Start the process of handing over control by reviewing your existing leadership practices. Assess the qualities and skills required in a leader for your business, and look within your workforce to see whether an existing colleague would make a suitable candidate. Before you approach a potential successor, set a salary level and any benefits you are prepared to offer.



Review the existing leadership

- › **Establish** who will most be affected by a leadership change.
- › **Determine** which qualities staff would want to see in their new boss.

Construct a leadership profile

- › **Reflect on** the attributes required to preserve and develop the business.
- › **Compile** a profile of skills and experience your successor needs.

Consider the potential candidates

- › **Consider** leadership potential of existing staff or family members.
- › **Look beyond** the business if necessary, to find recruits with required skills.